What is the process to follow if I need to upload more documents? Do I simply have to add them to the documents folder?

Yes, mostly — but there's one important nuance depending on what you're doing. Here's the complete picture:

Adding New Documents

Yes, drop the file into `C:\hrbuddy\documents\` and restart the backend. The `load_documents()` function runs on every startup and checks for files not yet in the database. It skips anything already indexed, so it only processes what's new. Your existing knowledge is preserved.

Steps:

1. Copy the new PDF/DOCX/TXT into `C:\hrbuddy\documents\`
2. Stop the running `uvicorn` window with `Ctrl+C`
3. Run `uvicorn main:app --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8000` again
4. Check the terminal — you should see `[INFO] Indexed X new chunks` with a non-zero number confirming the new file was picked up

Updating an Existing Document

This is the one case that needs an extra step. If you **replace a file with a newer version** (e.g., an updated leave policy PDF with the same filename), the backend won't re-index it — it sees the filename already in the database and skips it.

Steps for updating a document:

1. Delete `C:\hrbuddy\chroma_db\` (the entire folder)
2. Replace the old file in `C:\hrbuddy\documents\` with the new version
3. Restart the backend — it will re-index everything from scratch

This takes a minute or two on restart depending on how many documents you have, but it's a one-time cost each time you update.

Removing a Document

1. Delete the file from `C:\hrbuddy\documents\`
2. Delete `C:\hrbuddy\chroma_db\`
3. Restart — only the remaining files get indexed

Summary

Action	Steps
Add a brand new document	Drop in folder → restart backend
Update an existing document	Delete `chroma_db` folder + replace file → restart
Remove a document	Delete file + delete `chroma_db` folder → restart

The safe, foolproof rule for non-technical staff: **when in doubt, delete the `chroma_db` folder before restarting.** It always rebuilds cleanly and only takes a couple of extra minutes.

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1. image.jpg
2. image.jpg